

GA-HR-05

Fit for Duty & Substance-Free Workplace

The responsibility to work with sound judgement in a drug-free, alcohol-free, smoke-free, and vape-free school.

APPLIES TO

Gardner Academy employees and relevant staff

AUTHORITY

Gardner Academy staff standard

01 Policy statement

Employees must be physically and mentally able to perform their duties safely. Gardner Academy is a drug-free, alcohol-free, smoke-free, and vape-free workplace, including school events and duties away from the main site.

02 Prohibited conduct

Staff may not:

- Work while impaired by alcohol, illegal drugs, misused medication, or another substance.
- Possess, use, distribute, or sell prohibited substances on school property or while on school duty.
- Smoke or vape on school property, near students, in school vehicles, or during a school activity.
- Ignore a colleague whose condition may place children or others at risk.

03 Medication and health

A prescribed or over-the-counter medicine may affect alertness, coordination, or judgement. A staff member who may be unable to work safely must notify management confidentially before undertaking student supervision or another safety-sensitive task. Medical details will be handled with appropriate privacy.

04 When fitness is affected

An affected employee must stop the safety-sensitive duty, ensure students are transferred to another responsible adult, notify the designated manager immediately, and follow instructions concerning safe transport, medical assistance, or fitness to resume duty. Other staff must report an immediate risk and must not leave children under the supervision of a person they reasonably believe is impaired.

05 Support and accountability

Staff are encouraged to seek help early for a health or substance concern. Support does not remove the duty to protect children or prevent the school from addressing serious or repeated breaches through a fair HR process.